SYNTHETIC EXAMPLE POLICY -- NOT A REAL INSURER DOCUMENT
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Plan Name: Aetna Select POS 2025
Effective Date: January 1, 2025
Document Version: v1.0
Applies To: In-network and out-of-network benefits unless otherwise stated.

1 Overview of Covered Benefits

This Policy provides coverage for Medically Necessary services that are not otherwise excluded. Covered Benefits include, but are not limited to:

- Physician office visits and specialist consultations, including chronic-condition follow-up visits
- Outpatient behavioral health services, including individual psychotherapy
- Inpatient and outpatient orthopedic surgical procedures
- Emergency services
- Prescription drugs (Formulary-based)

2 Member Eligibility and Plan Status

Benefits are payable only if the member is enrolled and the Plan is active on the date of service. If the member's Plan is inactive at the time services are rendered, the claim will be denied. Denial reason: "Plan inactive at time of service."

3 Prior Authorization (Pre-Approval)

3.1 Services Requiring Prior Authorization

The following services require Prior Authorization:

- Elective inpatient admissions
- Non-emergency orthopedic surgery
- Durable medical equipment (DME) exceeding $500

Prior Authorization is NOT required for orthopedic surgery performed to treat an acute traumatic fracture in an urgent or emergency setting.

3.2 Documentation Required

Prior Authorization requests must include: (1) ordering provider's clinical note, (2) relevant diagnosis code(s), (3) prior treatment history (if applicable), and (4) expected service date and location. If documentation is missing, the request will be pended until complete information is received.

4 Medical Necessity Standard

A service is considered Medically Necessary if it is consistent with generally accepted standards of medical practice, clinically appropriate in type, frequency, and setting, not primarily for convenience of the member or provider, and the most cost-effective option among clinically comparable alternatives.

5 Coverage for Behavioral Health Services

5.1 Psychotherapy Coverage

Outpatient individual psychotherapy is covered when medical necessity is documented, specifically: a qualifying behavioral health diagnosis, a treatment plan or clinical note describing symptoms and functional impairment, and a stated treatment frequency. A denial for "insufficient documentation of medical necessity" may be overturned on appeal if new documentation (e.g., a clinical note with a diagnosis, symptom description, and treatment plan) is submitted that addresses the original insufficiency.

5.2 Orthopedic Surgical Coverage

Surgical treatment of a diagnosed fracture (e.g., hip fracture) is covered without Prior Authorization when performed in an urgent/emergency setting and supported by an

operative note and discharge summary.

6 Exclusions

The Plan does not cover: cosmetic or reconstructive procedures not required by trauma or congenital anomaly; services deemed not Medically Necessary; experimental or investigational treatments; services for which required Prior Authorization was not obtained; duplicate claims for the same service date and provider unless corrected and resubmitted.

7 Claims Processing Rules

7.1 Duplicate Claims

A claim is considered duplicate if Member ID, Provider NPI, Date of service, CPT / procedure code, and billed amount all match. Duplicate claims are denied with reason: "Duplicate claim submission."

7.2 Coding Consistency

Claims are routed for coding review if the diagnosis and procedure codes are clinically inconsistent based on standard coding guidelines. Such claims must not be approved until coding review is complete.

8 Appeals

Members and providers have the right to appeal a denial within 180 days. Appeals must include a written appeal request, the denial letter or claim reference number, and any new clinical documentation relevant to the denial reason. Appeals that include new, relevant clinical documentation addressing the original denial reason should be re-evaluated on the merits; appeals without new or relevant documentation may be upheld.

9 Contact Information

For questions about benefits, Prior Authorization, or claim status, contact Aetna Member Support at 1-800-555-0122 or via the Member Portal.